



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*devarṣirlomaśo dr̥ṣṭastataḥ prāpto'smyanusmṛtim d
divyaṃ cakṣurapi prāptaṃ jñānayogena vai purā e
dhṛtarāṣṭra uvāca d
ye tvanāthā janāstāta nāthavantaśca pāṇḍava d
kaccitteṣāṃ śarīrāṇi dhakṣyanti vidhipūrvakam e
yudhiṣṭhira uvāca d
na yeṣāṃ śāntikartāro na ca ye'trāhitāgnayaḥ d
vayaṃ ca teṣāṃ kuryāmo bahutvāttāta karmaṇām e*

— Bhishma (Chapter 11), Verses 20-22

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The scripture opens with a reminiscent tone, suggesting a deep connection to spiritual insight. Lomasa, a revered sage, is mentioned, and the speaker recalls a past attainment of divine vision through the practice of yoga and knowledge. This hints at the power of disciplined spiritual practice to unlock inner perception, a reminder to you that consistent effort in your own spiritual journey can lead to profound awakenings. Dhritarashtra, blinded both physically and by attachment, then inquires about the proper funerary rites for the fallen, specifically concerning those who are orphaned or have lost their protectors in the war. He wants to know if the bodies of the unprotected will be properly cremated.

Yudhishtira responds with a pragmatic yet compassionate approach. He explains that for those who lack family members to perform the necessary rituals, particularly those who have not maintained the sacred fire, the Pandavas themselves will undertake the responsibility, given the sheer number of casualties. This speaks to the importance of community and shared responsibility in times of crisis. It highlights the dharma of caring for the vulnerable and ensuring dignity in death, regardless of social standing.

In essence, this passage delves into themes of spiritual perception, responsibility toward the deceased, and communal support. It emphasizes that true spiritual progress involves not only personal enlightenment but also the practical application of compassion and ethical conduct in the world. Yudhishtira's response exemplifies selfless service and the recognition that even in the midst of war's devastation, dharma must prevail. The emphasis on performing final rites also speaks to the Hindu belief in the soul's journey and the importance of rituals in facilitating a peaceful transition.

For you today, this passage offers several valuable lessons. Firstly, it underscores the power of consistent spiritual practice to unlock deeper levels of awareness. Secondly, it reminds you of your responsibility to care for the vulnerable and ensure that all individuals are treated with dignity, especially in times of hardship. Finally, it highlights the importance of communal support and shared responsibility in addressing societal challenges. By embodying these principles in your own life, you can contribute to a more compassionate and just world.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

In what ways can you actively contribute to ensuring dignity and respect for all individuals, especially those who are marginalized or vulnerable, in your community today?